README

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mpdf

`mpdf` is a Windows-first command-line tool that converts Markdown files into polished PDF documents using Pandoc and XeLaTeX.

What This Product Does

LLMs are great at generating reports, summaries, notes, and technical documents in Markdown, but raw `.md` files usually do not look presentation-ready. `mpdf` solves that by turning Markdown into a clean, professional PDF with:

- a title, author, and date
- an optional table of contents
- syntax-highlighted code blocks
- properly rendered math
- support for images
- single source line breaks preserved as line breaks in the PDF
- cleaner typography than plain Markdown viewers

This is especially useful when:

- an LLM generates a report in `.md`
- you want to share the result as a polished PDF
- you need something that looks more like a finished document than a raw text export

TL;DR: Markdown is easy for humans and LLMs to generate, and `mpdf` makes it look good enough to send, print, or archive.

Setup

Prerequisites

Before using `mpdf`, install these tools:

- Python 3
- Pandoc
- TeX Live with `xelatex`

Helpful install options on Windows:

- Pandoc: https://pandoc.org/installing.html
- Pandoc via Winget: `winget install --id Pandoc.Pandoc`
- TeX Live: https://www.tug.org/texlive/
- Python: https://www.python.org/downloads/

Clone the Repository

```
git clone https://github.com/prajasw/md2pdf.git
cd md2pdf
```

Run It Directly

You can use the tool immediately with Python:

```
python .\mpdf.py .\example.md
```

Make `mpdf` Work Like a Global Command

If you want to run `mpdf` from anywhere in PowerShell or Command Prompt:

1. Keep `mpdf.py` and `mpdf.bat` in the same folder.
2. Add that folder to your Windows `PATH`.
3. Open a new terminal window.

Example folder:

```
C:\tools\mpdf
```

Then place these files there:

- `mpdf.py`
- `mpdf.bat`

After adding that folder to `PATH`, you can run:

```
mpdf report.md
```

How to Use It

Basic Command

```
mpdf <input.md> [--title "..."] [--author "..."] [--date YYYY-MM-DD] [--index]
```

Examples

Use defaults:

```
mpdf report.md
```

Override title, author, and date:

```
mpdf report.md --title "AI slop" --author "Prajas Wadekar" --date 2026-04-29
```

Include a table of contents:

```
mpdf report.md --index
```

Use a custom Pandoc LaTeX template:

```
mpdf report.md --template .\custom.tex
```

Put the title on its own page:

```
mpdf report.md --title-page
```

Defaults

If you do not supply metadata manually:

- `title` defaults to the input filename without the extension
- `author` defaults to `Prajas Wadekar`
- `date` defaults to today's date in `YYYY-MM-DD` format
- the table of contents is disabled unless you pass `--index`

If your Markdown file already contains YAML front matter, `mpdf` respects it. CLI arguments override YAML values when both are present.

Output

- The PDF is created in the same directory as the input file
- The output filename matches the Markdown filename

Example:

- input: `report.md`

- output: `report.pdf`

Example Workflow

1. Ask an LLM to generate a report in Markdown.
2. Save it as something like `analysis.md`.
3. Run:

```
mpdf analysis.md
```

4. Share the generated `analysis.pdf`.

That gives you a much more polished result than sending the raw Markdown file.

Obsidian Plugin

An Obsidian plugin is included in the `obsidian-plugin` folder to easily export your active note to a PDF in your `Downloads\Obsidian_pdf` folder using `mpdf`.

To install and use it:

1. Copy the `obsidian-plugin` folder to your vault's plugins directory (e.g., `.obsidian/plugins/mpdf-export`).
2. Restart Obsidian and enable "MPDF Export" in **Settings > Community Plugins**.
3. Open a Markdown note and click the new download icon in the left ribbon, or open the command palette (`Ctrl+P`) and run **"Export active note to Downloads as PDF"**.